

Catalyst of Change

Since founding Laurus Labs in 2005, CEO Satyanarayana Chava has overseen a series of transformations that has helped the firm become an integrated pharma company

By **Neetu Chandra Sharma**

PHOTO BY **KRISHNENDU HALDER**

► **LAURUS LABS**, once a leading manufacturer of antiretroviral (ARV) drugs, is undergoing yet another transformation under Satyanarayana Chava, its Founder & CEO. Until 2011, ARVs—a group of medication used to manage and treat human immunodeficiency virus (HIV) infection—accounted for a substantial portion of the company's revenue. Then it made a strategic shift towards becoming an active pharmaceutical ingredient (API)-focussed company.

Subsequently, the company forayed into the formulations business in 2014, which helped it become an integrated pharma company by 2020. As a result of that shift, the ARV API contributes only 25% of revenues now, while the contract development and manufacturing organisation (CDMO) segment has seen significant growth.

The success of these shifts is evident in the numbers. Over the past five years, Laurus Labs, which was found-

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Pharma & Healthcare

SATYANARAYANA CHAVA

FOUNDER & CEO, LAURUS LABS

Revenue from operations	FY23	6,040.6
	9MFY24	3,601.2
Profit before tax	FY23	1,108.9
	9MFY24	129.1
Profit after tax	FY23	796.6
	9MFY24	92.9
	FY23 RoE (%)	21.63
	Market Cap	21,493.9

● Data is on a consolidated basis; all figures in ₹ crore except RoE; 9MFY24: April-December 2023

● M-cap as of February 23, 2024

● **Source** ACE Equity, BSE



LEADING FROM THE FRONT Satyanarayana Chava, Founder & CEO, Laurus Labs